Palatial Pools

OpenHands User Guide

1. Introduction and Access

OpenHands is your autonomous agent framework, designed to orchestrate complex development and administrative tasks directly on the Palatial Pools Virtual Private Server. By utilizing the advanced reasoning capabilities of the OpenAI o3 model, OpenHands can understand multi-step instructions, write code, execute terminal commands, and navigate the web to achieve specific objectives.

This guide provides the necessary instructions to access, utilize, and optimize your interactions with OpenHands.

How to Access and Log In

Access to OpenHands is strictly controlled via Basic Authentication to ensure the security of the Palatial Pools infrastructure.

Navigate to the designated URL for the service: `https://autopilot.palatialpools.com.au`. Upon accessing the page, your browser will prompt you for credentials.

Enter your authorized username, `kieran`, and the corresponding administrative password. Once authenticated, you will be presented with the OpenHands interface, ready to accept your instructions.

2. Step-by-Step Usage Instructions

Operating OpenHands involves providing clear, objective-oriented prompts and monitoring its progress as it executes the necessary steps to complete the task.

1. **Initiate a Session**: Ensure you have a clear goal in mind before starting a new session. OpenHands does not retain memory between sessions, so each new interaction begins with a clean slate.
2. **Provide the Initial Prompt**: In the primary input field, describe the task you want OpenHands to accomplish. Be as specific as possible about the desired outcome, the files involved, and any constraints.
3. **Monitor Execution**: OpenHands will begin planning and executing steps. You can observe its thought process, the commands it runs in the terminal, and the files it creates or modifies.
4. **Review and Iterate**: Once OpenHands indicates it has completed the task, review the results. If the outcome is not exactly as desired, provide follow-up instructions in the same session to refine the work.
5. **Conclude the Session**: When the task is satisfactorily completed, you can close the session. Remember that closing or refreshing the session will clear its memory.

3. Task Capabilities

OpenHands is highly versatile and capable of handling a wide array of technical tasks. Its ability to create sandboxed environments allows it to safely experiment and execute complex operations.

What Kinds of Tasks It Can Handle

The system excels at tasks that require reasoning, file manipulation, and terminal access.

Task Category	Examples
Code Orchestration	Developing new scripts, refactoring existing code, or writing automated tests.
System Administration	Configuring server services, managing files, or analyzing log files for errors.
Web Interaction	Browsing documentation, retrieving specific information, or interacting with web APIs.
Environment Management	Creating sandboxed environments to safely execute and test untrusted code.

4. Best Practices for Prompting

To maximize the effectiveness of OpenHands and minimize unnecessary API costs, it is crucial to employ effective prompting strategies.

The most important practice is to be explicit and detailed in your initial instructions. Provide context about the environment, the location of relevant files, and the exact format of the desired output. Ambiguity can lead the agent down incorrect paths, consuming time and resources.

When dealing with complex, multi-file projects, break the objective down into smaller, logical steps. Ask OpenHands to complete one step at a time, reviewing the output before proceeding to the next. This iterative approach ensures the agent stays on track and reduces the likelihood of compounding errors.

Always specify constraints. If a task must not modify certain files or must adhere to a specific coding standard, state these requirements clearly in the prompt.

5. Common Issues and Resolutions

While OpenHands is a powerful tool, you may occasionally encounter operational issues. Understanding these common problems can help you quickly resolve them and

resume your work.

Memory Resets

A frequent point of confusion is the loss of context. OpenHands is designed to reset its memory between sessions. If you close the browser tab or start a new session, the agent will not remember previous instructions or the context of ongoing tasks. To resolve this, you must provide all necessary context in the initial prompt of each new session.

Execution Delays

OpenHands can be slow when processing complex tasks, especially those involving multiple files or extensive reasoning by the o3 model. If the agent appears to be stuck, observe the terminal output and its thought process. It may simply be working through a difficult problem. However, if it loops continuously without making progress, it is best to interrupt the session and provide a more structured, step-by-step prompt.

High API Costs

The advanced reasoning capabilities of the OpenAI o3 model come at a premium. Extensive use of OpenHands, particularly for simple tasks that could be automated via scripts, can quickly escalate API costs. To mitigate this, reserve OpenHands for complex problem-solving and orchestration tasks, and utilize more cost-effective solutions for routine operations.

© 2026 Palatial Pool Services Pty Ltd. Internal Technical Documentation.